

CAMBRIDGE O LEVEL – ISLAMIYAT 2058/12

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Question 1

I have chosen passages (1) and (3).

(a) Main Themes

Passage (1) – Sura 41:37

The main theme of this passage is the Oneness of God, known as Tawhid. The Sura tells us that the night, the day, the sun and the moon are all signs (ayat) of Allah's power and existence. However, we are not supposed to worship these things – they are just creations. Instead we must worship only Allah who made them all. So another theme is the rejection of shirk, which means associating partners with God. Pagans at the time of the Prophet used to worship the sun and moon, and this ayah directly tells them that is wrong.

Passage (3) – Sura 112

Sura 112, also called Surah Al-Ikhlâs, is entirely about Tawhid – the absolute oneness of Allah. It tells us that Allah is Ahad (one and only), that He is As-Samad (eternal and self-sufficient), that He was not born and does not have children, and that nothing in all of creation is like Him. These themes together describe exactly what Muslims believe about God's nature.

(b) Importance in a Muslim's Life Today

Passage (1) – Sura 41:37

This passage is very important for Muslims today because it reminds them not to get too attached to worldly things. Just like the pagans worshipped the sun and moon, people today can sometimes worship money, celebrities or power. This ayah warns Muslims to keep their focus on Allah alone. It also teaches Muslims to look at nature – the changing of day and night, the movement of the moon – and see these as signs of Allah. This helps a Muslim feel closer to Allah in their daily life and feel a sense of gratitude and wonder.

Passage (3) – Sura 112

Sura 112 is extremely important in a Muslim's daily life. The Prophet (PBUH) said it is equal to one-third of the Quran in reward, so Muslims recite it many times every day in their prayers. It also helps Muslims stay firm in their belief and not be confused by other religions that believe in the Trinity or multiple gods. It gives a clear definition of who Allah is. It also helps Muslims explain their faith to non-Muslims in a simple and clear way.

Question 2

(a) What the Qur'an Teaches About God's Responsibility and Human Duties

The Qur'an teaches us a great deal about the relationship between Allah and His creation. This relationship is a two-way one – Allah has responsibilities towards His creatures and in return humans have duties towards Him.

In Sura Al-Fatiha (Sura 1), we see that Allah is described as Rabb ul Alamin – the Lord and Sustainer of all the worlds. This shows that it is Allah's responsibility to take care of and provide for all of creation. He is also called Ar-Rahman and Ar-Rahim, meaning the Most Gracious and the Most Merciful, which tells us He is full of mercy and compassion towards His creatures. He is the Master of the Day of Judgement, which shows He is also responsible for judging our actions fairly.

In Sura 2:21–22, Allah directly addresses humans and tells them to worship Him alone, because He created them and those who came before them. He reminds them that He made the earth a resting place and the sky a canopy, and sends down rain from the sky to grow fruits for them to eat. So His responsibility is to provide everything humans need – food, shelter, and life itself. The human's duty in return is to worship only Allah and not set up rivals to Him.

Sura 96:1–5 speaks about knowledge. Allah taught man what he did not know, using the pen as a symbol of learning. This shows that Allah's responsibility also includes giving humans knowledge and intellect, which separates them from animals. In return, humans must use this knowledge in a responsible way and acknowledge that it comes from God.

Sura 99, the Sura of the Earthquake, tells us that on the Day of Judgement the earth will show everything that happened on it, and every person will see the results of their deeds, no matter how small. This shows that Allah is responsible for holding everyone to account justly, and that humans have a duty to behave properly because nothing escapes Allah's knowledge.

Finally, Sura 114 teaches us that Allah is the King, the Holy One, and the Lord of mankind, and that He protects humans from the evil whispers of Shaytan. So humans should turn to Allah for protection and refuge. In return, humans must acknowledge His lordship.

Overall, the Qur'an presents a balanced relationship: Allah is the Provider, Protector, and Judge, and humans must respond with worship, gratitude and righteous conduct.

(b) The Qur'an and Environmental Responsibility

I agree with this statement. The Qur'an teaches in Sura 2:22 that Allah made the earth a resting place for humans and provided all their needs from it. This means the earth is a gift from Allah and humans should take care of it and not destroy it. Also, since everything belongs to Allah (as Sura 42:4 tells us), humans are just caretakers (khalifas) of the earth, not its owners. Therefore they do not have the right to exploit or destroy the environment. If Muslims damage the environment, they are being ungrateful for the blessings Allah has given them.

Question 3

(a) How the Prophet Started to Preach Islam

The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) began receiving revelation at the age of 40, when he was in the Cave of Hira. The first verses revealed were from Sura 96 (Iqra), telling him to read in the

name of his Lord who created. This was a huge and frightening experience for the Prophet and he rushed home to his wife Khadija, who comforted him. Khadija then took him to her cousin Waraqa bin Nawfal, a Christian scholar, who confirmed that the Prophet had received the same revelation that came to Prophet Moses. Waraqa said he would support the Prophet but died not long after.

After this, there was a pause in revelation called the *Fatrah*. Then revelation began again, this time with verses from Sura Al-Mudaththir, which instructed the Prophet to rise and warn people. From this point, revelation came regularly.

For the first three years, the Prophet preached in complete secrecy. He only shared the message with people he trusted. The first to accept Islam was Khadija (RA), his wife. Then came Ali ibn Abi Talib (RA), the Prophet's young cousin who lived in his household. After him, Zayd bin Haritha (RA), the Prophet's freed slave, accepted Islam. Then Abu Bakr (RA), the Prophet's closest friend, became Muslim. Abu Bakr was very influential and through his efforts several prominent companions such as Uthman ibn Affan, Abdur-Rahman ibn Awf, Zubayr ibn al-Awwam, and others accepted Islam.

During this secret period, the Muslims would gather quietly, often going to the mountains outside Makkah to pray, to avoid being seen by the Quraysh. They prayed twice a day. The Prophet taught them the new revelations he received.

After about three years, when the number of Muslims had grown to over forty, the Prophet received a command through Sura 26:214 to warn his nearest relatives. He invited his clan, the Banu Hashim, to a dinner and announced the message of Islam. Abu Lahab, his uncle, was angry and rejected the message immediately.

After this, the Prophet went to the Mount of Safa and called out to all the people of Makkah, asking them if they would believe him if he told them an army was coming. They said yes, they trust him. He then told them he was warning them of a severe punishment if they did not abandon their idols and worship one God. Again, Abu Lahab rejected him angrily. The public preaching had begun, and with it came persecution of the early Muslims.

(b) Was it Significant that the Prophet Began Preaching in Secret?

Yes, I believe it was very significant. Preaching in secret was a wise and necessary strategy at that time. The message of Islam was completely new and revolutionary for the people of Makkah who had worshipped idols for generations. If the Prophet had announced it publicly from the beginning, the Quraysh would have immediately crushed the small group of Muslims before they had any strength.

By preaching in secret, the Prophet was able to build a solid and committed group of followers who truly understood and believed in the message. These were people who chose Islam out of conviction, not social pressure. They formed the strong foundation of the Muslim community. Also, the Prophet himself needed time to receive more revelation and learn how to guide his followers. So the secret phase was not just strategic – it was divinely planned, as Allah guided the Prophet step by step.

Question 5

(a) The Prophet's Wife Aisha During the Prophet's Lifetime

Aisha bint Abi Bakr (RA) was one of the most remarkable people in early Islamic history. She was the daughter of Abu Bakr (RA), the Prophet's closest companion. She married the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) at a young age and became one of his most beloved wives.

Aisha was known from a very young age for her extraordinary intelligence and her sharp memory. Because she lived so closely with the Prophet in his household, she had the unique opportunity to observe his every action, word, and habit. This placed her in an unmatched position to learn and then later teach others about Islam.

During the Prophet's lifetime, whenever a new revelation came, Aisha would learn it and understand it. She would ask the Prophet questions, even on sensitive or difficult matters, showing that she was not afraid to seek knowledge. The Prophet encouraged this and would explain things to her carefully.

Aisha also participated in some of the battles during the Prophet's lifetime. She accompanied the Muslims on some expeditions, including the Battle of Uhud, where women helped by carrying water and tending to the wounded.

One of the most important events during her life with the Prophet was the incident of the necklace (known as Hadith al-lfk). During a military expedition, Aisha fell behind the caravan and returned to the camp the next day with a young companion. Malicious people spread false rumours about her. This caused great distress to the Prophet and the community for about a month. Eventually, Allah revealed verses (Sura 24:11–19) declaring Aisha innocent and condemning those who had spread the rumour. This event showed the gravity of making false accusations.

Aisha was so close to the Prophet that he passed away in her room, resting his head on her lap. This shows how special and beloved she was to him.

(b) Is Aisha a Role Model for Muslim Women Today?

I strongly agree that Aisha is a role model for Muslim women around the world. She narrated over 2000 hadiths, which means she is one of the greatest sources of Islamic knowledge that we have today. Both men and women came from far away to learn from her. This shows that women can and should be scholars and teachers of religion.

Aisha also shows that a Muslim woman can be confident, intelligent, and outspoken. She never hesitated to question things she did not understand and she corrected mistakes when she saw them. She was not silent or passive. For Muslim women today who are sometimes told they should not seek education or speak up, Aisha is a powerful example of the opposite.

Furthermore, Aisha shows that being a devoted wife and a great scholar are not opposites – she managed to be both at the same time. This balance is inspiring for Muslim women today who try to balance their personal lives with their roles in society.